CHAPTER 01 | AROUND 2000-2007, WITH EARLIER MEMORIES CLEARLY IDENTIFIED

Fiango

Football, friendship, unpaid school fees, and a gifted boy's growing determination to give his mother a better life.

Dramatic question What happens when a boy who can invent a solution to anything meets a problem he cannot talk his way out of?

Act I - Setup

Street football introduces Zino's wit, competitiveness, and temper. Luc and Gideo hear his outrageous stories about Grand-Chukuchuku, the man who achieves what nobody else can. Brief fantasy sequences make those boasts visible before returning us to the real game. The neighboring houses, shared well, and central mango tree establish the compound as the emotional center of his world. At home, his mother's belief gives his confidence a foundation. Beneath the jokes lies a lasting desire: to build her a house.

Turning point: His imagination can win an argument, but the family's financial limits cannot be wished away.

Act II - Confrontation

Education reveals both Zino's ability and the limits of that advantage. His earlier primary-school fee exclusion can return as a clearly placed memory; the later high-school exclusion belongs at its actual date. His mother's teaching income and his uncle's intermittent help keep opportunity alive without removing uncertainty. Boarding school in Kumba supplies comic escapes over the fence to eat at home. Friendships, first love, and Miss Mukete's influence enter at their confirmed ages. His wish to impress people begins to compete with his need to be honest about what he cannot control.

Turning point: Being the cleverest boy in the room does not guarantee that he can remain in it.

Act III - Consequence

Zino completes secondary school in 2007. Academic progress creates a new threshold rather than financial security. The closing movement should grow from a remembered examination, result, or family conversation, making clear what this achievement means to him and his mother. Grand-Chukuchuku can still supply effortless victories; Zino's real future requires help, patience, and choices. The child who dreams of lifting his mother out of hardship now faces the practical requirements of further education. The chapter ends with a milestone achieved and the next opportunity still uncertain.

Turning point: He has the ability to continue, but the household still needs a way to pay.

CHAPTER 01 | DEVELOPMENT PAGE

Make this chapter yours

Fiango

At the beginning	At ten, Zino has completed primary school and lives with his mother in Fiango.
At the end	Secondary school is complete in 2007; his ambition now depends on finding a way to continue.

Three possible short episodes

1. Grand-Chukuchuku Never Loses

A football dispute introduces the imaginary hero and the real boy's difficulty accepting an unfavorable decision.

2. The Fence

A boarding-school escape for a meal at home reveals ingenuity, appetite, and the pull of belonging.

3. School Fees

At the remembered age, a fee exclusion interrupts academic confidence and changes the rhythm of an ordinary school day.

Memory prompts

1. Which secondary school did you enter, when did boarding begin, and what did the uniform look like?

2. Describe a fee-exclusion day: who spoke, how you returned home, and what happened next.

3. Reconstruct one fence-jumping trip: companions, route, food, and any consequences.

4. When did Luc, Gideo, Elianne, and Miss Mukete enter your life? Give one defining memory of each.

Grand-Chukuchuku motif Grand-Chukuchuku is playful and spectacular: imaginary victories contrast with ordinary limits.

Details still open: The opening is at ten, after primary completion in 1999. The previously drafted age-ten fee scene is a proposed composite, not a confirmed dated memory.